In this chapter you'll learn the syntax for defining objects, how object properties and values work as key-value stores, how to write comprehensions for objects, how to structure data using objects, how prototypes work, how functions are bound to objects, and finally how common behavior among many objects is efficiently achieved with CoffeeScript's class syntax.

4.1. Syntax

CoffeeScript has some types that you've encountered already. They are numbers, strings, booleans, functions, null, and undefined. Everything else is an object. Objects with properties and values are declared using either the literal brace notation familiar to JavaScript developers or a minimalist CoffeeScript syntax, described in this section.

4.1.1. Literals

One way to get a brand-new empty object, assigned to a variable, is with an object literal:

```
brandSpankingNewObject = {}
anotherOne = {}
```

To impress your friends, immediately start referring to this as *ex nihilo* object creation. *Ex nihilo* is a Latin term that means "out of nothing." An object created using the literal notation isn't created from something else—it's just *there*, out of nothing.

4.1.2. Properties

Objects contain properties. Each property has a name and associated value. An object with one property `title` and value `'Way of the Dragon'` looks like this:

```
{title: 'Way of the Dragon'}
```